

Social Networking on iPhone

There are thousands of social networking apps available on the iTunes store, but the most popular is the one developed by Facebook

Who owns Facebook!

Paul D. Ceglia claims filed a lawsuit in New York Superior Court, claiming that he had a contract with Mark Zuckerberg which grants him 84 per cent ownership of Facebook

INTERVIEW

NIKIL VISWANATHAN CO-FOUNDER, FOUNTAINHOP

What inspired you to start Fountainhop?

Fountainhop actually started off as a class project for one of my entrepreneurship classes at Stanford and we ran with the idea over winter break after the class ended. We realised that even with all of the amazing technology we have today, there is still no good way for college students (and people in general) to find out what's going on around them especially in terms of events and their friends.



Why Fountainhop?

Fountainhopping is a tradition here at Stanford – basically we run around and jump around and play in the fountains at all times of the year. It's a lot of fun and one of my favourite traditions at Stanford. The first day of classes my freshmen year, our dorm staff woke us all up at 5 AM and our entire dorm went jumping and playing from one fountain to the next through all of the major fountains on campus – it was absolutely amazing!

Right now Fountainhop seems to be confined to college students. What about the rest of the world?

We'll see; all we care about right now is that it's useful to college students.

What role did your education play in developing Fountainhop?

It's been absolutely invaluable; I've gotten a lot of experience building various different pieces of software and am extremely glad to have had this opportunity to study here at Stanford. Really, it's been all about the people though; the friends that I've met here have been immensely inspiring and have made me reach out to try my best.

Any inspiring words for college students in India?

Just go for it. The best advice I've gotten is to just do it. Build something, try it out, and try launching it. If it works, great! If it doesn't work you just got a lot of experience. Seriously just try building something, release it and see how it goes, that's my main piece of advice.

up with this quaint name "Fountainhop" for their application? In the blog on their website, this is how they try to explain the significance of the term – "The collegiate tradition to tour the college by exploring and jumping in all the fountains the campus has to offer – literally hopping from one fountain to the next."

Fountainhop makes networking easy by allowing users to automatically make their locations public on the app itself, or by posting a status update on Facebook profile. At all points of time, the users, students in this case, enjoy complete control on how much information they want to reveal and how much they want to safeguard. When quizzed

about his foray into mobile app space, Zavain Dar, who is a student at Stanford says, "I'm particularly a fan of just doing it." Another co-founder of Fountainhop, Nikil Viswanathan, who is also at Stanford, elaborates, "Currently we don't have a business point of view, we just want to make something that's extremely useful to college students. We have started offering Fountainhop for free and we do hope that from here it will spread to other colleges around the country and beyond."

Unlike the smartphone application called Foursquare, which is open to anyone, Fountainhop

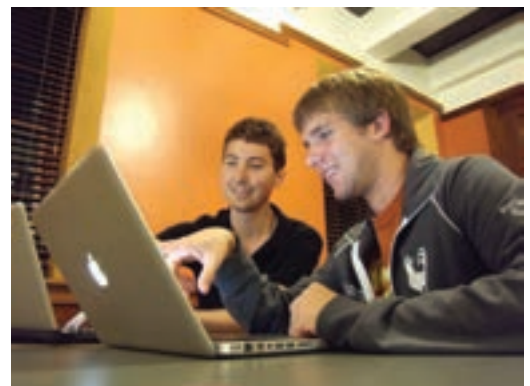


Too busy Fountain hopping to work?

requires a netID of Harvard, Princeton or Stanford for users to post events. All the updates get automatically sorted according to the time, and they are colour-coded by category to make it easier for users to understand their relevance in a quick and easy manner. However, a lot of tweaking is still going on in the application and it is still too early to say how things are going to evolve. You might even be confronted with a completely different looking avatar of Fountainhop by the time you read this.

Scoop

When you point your browser to <http://inthescoop.com>, you're faced with a rhetorical question, "Are you in the scoop?" As of writing this, the application is still under development, but it might be released in a few weeks. According to a report published in VentureBeat, a venture-capital investment firm owned by Google CEO Eric Schmidt has made an investment in Trumpet Technologies, the Palo Alto-based start-up currently



The Scoop team hard at work